

PREMIUM

Refusal Decision Guide

Appeals, reapplying, and what actually changes the outcome

Understand your options after a refusal

Outcome	What it means	What you can do
Refusal	The consulate checked one or more specific grounds on the standardised EU refusal form (Annex VI) - most commonly insurance, financial evidence, or doubts about your intention to leave.	You have a right of appeal, and/or you can reapply.
Appeal	A formal challenge to the refusal, under the national law of the member state that decided your case - not a single EU-wide procedure.	Your refusal form states the specific authority and deadline for your case - read it carefully, since this genuinely differs by country.
Reapplication	A new application, assessed fresh.	Often faster than an appeal, and commonly the more practical path - but only if you've actually addressed the stated refusal ground(s).

Read your refusal form closely

The standardised form lists the exact ground(s) checked for your case. Address that specific reason directly in any appeal or reapplication - don't guess, and don't submit a generic response.

If you plan to reapply: what actually helps

- Fix the specific documented gap - insurance meeting the minimum, clearer financial evidence, a more specific itinerary, better-documented ties at home
- Confirm you applied (or are reapplying) to the consulate actually responsible for your itinerary
- Consider a brief cover letter explaining what's changed since the refusal (see the Cover Letter templates, Complete tier)

What not to do

- Don't reapply immediately with an unchanged application

- Don't omit a previous refusal or overstay on a later application - this is checked through the shared Visa Information System (VIS) across all Schengen states
- Don't submit materially false information to work around a previous refusal

When to seek professional advice

Consider consulting an immigration lawyer in the country that refused you if you've been refused multiple times, if you're considering a formal appeal, or if your case involves more complex history across multiple Schengen states.